

Blizzard: a backbone team and new game launches

Account entry plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo

91 Data Center intent, audience A	91 Networking Solutions intent (Sep 26)	16 Blizzard contacts in HubSpot	0 touches so far
STAGE Prospect. No deal.	RUNNING NOW CTF INTL (Tim Sun), added Sep 30	LAST TOUCH Sep 30: enrollment only	NEXT STEP Tue Oct 6: email Dan Cicioiu (Manager, Backbone Network Engineering)

Bottom line

Blizzard (about 5,000 people, Irvine) runs its own game backbone. It showed **Data Center 91 (audience A)** and **Networking Solutions 91** in September. At **BlizzCon (Sep 13)** it announced **Diablo V**, a **StarCraft shooter** and **WoW: Forever**, with releases aimed at 2029-30; new games eventually mean more server capacity. Chicago has long been one of the central US hubs for game traffic. The backbone owners are in HubSpot but untouched: **Dan Cicioiu (Manager, Backbone Network Engineering)** and **Catalina Cicioiu (Sr Manager, Network and Data Center Engineering)**.

What Blizzard is, in one analogy

Blizzard is a theme park planning new rides. Before the rides open, it needs wider roads to the parking lot.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Data Center 91 (A), Networking Solutions 91, Cloud 74	ZoomInfo intent	Infrastructure research.
BlizzCon Sep 13: Diablo V, StarCraft shooter, WoW: Forever	ZoomInfo scoops	Long-range growth.
Engineering roles at a 6-month high, including network simulation	ZoomInfo scoop	Building.

Work already in motion

Only one international-list enrollment.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
Sep 30	CTF INTL	Tim Sun (Sr Network Engineer II)	US engineer in the wrong list

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Dan Cicioiu	Manager, Backbone Network Engineering (HubSpot)	n/a	Backbone owner.	Not contacted. dcicioiu@blizzard.com
Catalina Cicioiu	Sr Manager, Network and Data Center Engineering (HubSpot)	n/a	Data center owner.	Not contacted
Xiaodong Wang	Network Manager (HubSpot)	n/a	Network.	Not contacted
Tim Sun	Senior Network Engineer II (HubSpot)	n/a	Technical.	INTL; move

Not worth chasing for this goal

Data center engineers (operators) and events network staff.

How the access path should run



Messages, by contact

1. Dan Cicioiu Manager, Backbone Network Engineering

Why them: Backbone owner.

Channel: Email Tue Oct 6 | Subject: A Chicago segment for Blizzard's backbone

Dan, with new titles on the roadmap, I'd guess backbone capacity is on your list. Crosstown owns underground fiber in Chicago, on-net at Equinix and Digital Realty at 350 E Cermak and Equinix CH3, mapped to the conduit. We offer both leases and IRUs. Can I send the KMZ?

2. Catalina Cicioiu Sr Manager, Network and Data Center Engineering

Why them: Data center owner.

Channel: Email Thu Oct 8 | Subject: Chicago data center paths

Catalina, if Blizzard is looking at Chicago data center space, we can show which buildings we link on diverse, documented paths. 20 minutes?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Fri Oct 2	Move Tim Sun out of INTL.	-
Tue Oct 6	Email Dan Cicioiu.	-
Thu Oct 8	Email Catalina Cicioiu.	-
Week of Oct 19	Goal: backbone call.	-

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Reply	Logged
Nov 6	Backbone call held	Meeting logged

Guardrails

- Gaming networks favor flexible leases (i3D's reply); lead with lease options.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts; Lemlist CTF INTL; ZoomInfo intent and scoops; i3D reply (Oct 1) for context.